exaggerated at all, quite the contrary; but they could have not imagined either the pogroms or the Orwellian style of government. Soviet-type Communism did come to Europe, but to its Eastern part, with Western consent given in Yalta. And not only that: Communist parties in the West grew in strength, in particular in France and Italy, which was causing some concern throughout the Cold War, especially to Americans. The Soviet Union's colossal loss of human lives during the war was rewarded with domination of Central and Eastern Europe and even with strong Communist parties in the West.

The Communist systems imposed after World War II in Central, South-Eastern and Eastern Europe had much in common but, across the region and over the decades in which they existed, they were not all exactly the same. The Hungarian uprising of 1956 and the Prague Spring of 1968 were able to take place because of the strong, liberally minded middle class which existed in these countries (at least in their capital cities) and which had a pre-war tradition of democratic life. In Poland, the Catholic Church, because of its strong traditions, featured as the most important informal opposition force. In the Baltic countries, their inclusion in the Soviet Union was, in fact, an annexation and it was followed by a mass immigration of Russian-speakers (and forced emigration of unreliable elements of the local population to the Russian Far East), with the purpose of changing the ethnic structure of the populace. The consequences of this still resonate today in the issue of the Russian community in the Baltic states. By conservative estimates, Soviet mass deportations saw between 200,000 and 400,000 people expelled by force from the Baltics and moved to Siberia and Kazakhstan.[77] On the other hand, the (forced?) migration of ethnic Russians to the Baltics results today in around 6% of the population in Lithuania being ethnic Russian and almost a third in Latvia and Estonia.[78] Luckily, 'their supposed loyalty to Russia is far from black-and-white.'[79]

In Yugoslavia, which was, apart from Albania, the only country of the former Communist bloc that was not in the Warsaw Treaty, the Communist regime was generally believed to be softer. Tito was even proposed for the Nobel Peace Prize. Yet his Yugoslavia had prisons full of political opponents and even a concentration camp on a barren Croatian island, next to the island of Rab, where the Italian Fascists ran a concentration camp only a couple of years before. In fact, this notorious Goli Otok camp was